Spring option 2

What we are eating

- **Lunch, Mon to Wed:** Lentil soup
- **Lunch, Thu and Fri (and Wednesday's dinner):** Teriyaki tofu bowls
- **Dinner, Mon and Tue:** Kopytka (potato dumplings)
- **Dinner, Thu and Fri:** Tofu stir fry
- **Breakfast:** Egg muffins **Snack:** Granola bars
- **For him only:** Plain baked chicken breast, diced: 10 portions of 100 g (about 1.3 kg raw), added to his lunches, Wednesday's dinner and the kopytka.
- **Weekend:** Barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht) for lunch and Zapiekanka for dinner, both days; eggs on toast for breakfast.

The week at a glance

DAYS	BREAKFAST	LUNCH (PACKED)	SNACK	DINNER	DAY TOTAL
Mon, Tue	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Lentil soup** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 100 g diced chicken 640 kcal, 56 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cheddar 30 g 507 kcal, 26 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Kopytka (potato dumplings)** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 629 kcal, 44 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 448 kcal, 24 g	**HIM 2152 kcal**, 161 g **HER 1717 kcal**, 92 g
Wed	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Lentil soup** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 100 g diced chicken 640 kcal, 56 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cheddar 30 g 507 kcal, 26 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Teriyaki tofu bowls** **HIM** 4 parts + 1/2 cup brown rice + 100 g diced chicken 610 kcal, 50 g **HER** 3 parts + 3/4 cup brown rice + edamame 100 g 534 kcal, 27 g	**HIM 2132 kcal**, 167 g **HER 1803 kcal**, 95 g
Thu, Fri	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Teriyaki tofu bowls** **HIM** 4 parts + 1/2 cup brown rice + 100 g diced chicken 610 kcal, 50 g **HER** 3 parts + 3/4 cup brown rice + edamame 100 g 534 kcal, 27 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Tofu stir fry** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 1/4 cup brown rice 608 kcal, 31 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 cup brown rice 470 kcal, 24 g	**HIM 2100 kcal**, 143 g **HER 1766 kcal**, 92 g
Sat	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht)** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 100 g diced chicken 707 kcal, 44 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cottage cheese 125 g 536 kcal, 25 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Zapiekanka** **HIM** 4 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 621 kcal, 38 g **HER** 3 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 498 kcal, 33 g	**HIM 2261 kcal**, 140 g **HER 1812 kcal**, 95 g
Sun	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht)** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 100 g diced chicken 707 kcal, 44 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cottage cheese 125 g 536 kcal, 25 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Zapiekanka** **HIM** 4 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 621 kcal, 38 g **HER** 3 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 498 kcal, 33 g	**HIM 2261 kcal**, 140 g **HER 1812 kcal**, 95 g

"4 parts" and "3 parts" are the his and hers shares of a cooked dish. Numbers are kcal and grams of protein.

The rhythm

Sunday, about 2 hours

1. Start with lentil soup (about 55 min). Make the recipe once (6 servings).
2. Then egg muffins (about 40 min). Make 2 x the recipe (24 muffins).
3. Then granola bars (25 min of work plus 2 hours chilling). Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (15 bars).
4. Bake his chicken: about 1.3 kg raw breast with salt, pepper, garlic powder and a little oil, 20 to 25 min at 425 F. Dice it and bag 10 portions of 100 g. Keep 3 in the fridge and freeze the rest, moving them down a day ahead.
5. Cook brown rice for the lunch boxes: 2 1/2 cups cooked (160 g dry).
6. Box the lunches for Monday to Wednesday. Teriyaki tofu bowls is cooked fresh on Wednesday evening.

The rest of the week

Monday	Cook Kopytka (potato dumplings) (about 40 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow.
Tuesday	No cooking. Leftovers from Monday.
Wednesday	Cook teriyaki tofu bowls (about 30 min). Eat it for dinner and box Thursday's and Friday's lunches.
Thursday	Cook tofu stir fry (about 25 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow.
Friday	No cooking.
Saturday	Midday: make barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht) (about 105 min) for today's and tomorrow's lunch. Evening: cook Zapiekanka (about 30 min) for tonight's and tomorrow's dinner. Breakfast both days is eggs on toast.
Sunday	Leftovers from Saturday for lunch and dinner. Afternoon: prep the next option.

Groceries used: $197.97 for both of you for the seven days ($98.98 each). Buying every pack new costs about $336.10 at the till; most of the difference stays in the pantry for later options.

Shopping list: Spring option 2

For both of you, Monday to Sunday. Save-On-Foods prices seen Nov 10, 2026. Check the fridge and pantry first: oats, rice, soy sauce, honey, peanut butter and oil last for several options.

From H Mart, not priced

Cooking sake (or any dry sake). Tofu, ginger, green onions and mushrooms are usually cheaper there too.

Pantry check (not on the list below)

Salt, pepper, neutral cooking oil, sugar or brown sugar, flour, cornstarch, vinegar, plus: cumin, coriander, paprika, bay leaves, cornstarch or potato starch, sesame seeds, dried basil, oregano, vanilla, cinnamon, sunflower seeds, coconut flakes, dried thyme (and about 325 g of the flour), chili paste (sambal oelek), thyme or rosemary, allspice, juniper berries, cloves, marjoram, 2 prunes, 10 dried wild mushrooms, 500 mL beet kvass, ketchup, garlic powder.

ITEM	NEED	BUY	PACK PRICE	COST OF AMOUNT USED
Produce				
☐ Ambrosia apple	7.5	8 x each, about 207 g	$0.91	$6.83
☐ Baby spinach (Western Family)	343 g	3 x 142 g	$4.99	$12.05
☐ Beets, loose	400 g	loose, by weight	$0.66/100 g	$2.64
☐ Carrots	310 g	1 x 5 lb bag	$7.99	$1.09
☐ Celery	150 g	1 x bunch, about 675 g	$5.49	$1.22
☐ Celery root	245 g	1 x about 355 g	$3.12	$2.15
☐ Fresh ginger	15 g	loose, by weight	$0.66/100 g	$0.10
☐ Garlic	0.7 bulb	1 x 3 bulbs	$1.29	$0.30
☐ Grape tomatoes	220 g	1 x 284 g	$3.99	$3.09
☐ Green bell pepper	1	1 x each	$2.11	$2.11
☐ Green onions	1.4 bunch	2 x bunch	$2.49	$3.49
☐ Leek	1	1 x each	$2.12	$2.12
☐ Lemon	1	1 x each	$0.99	$0.99
☐ Red bell pepper	1	1 x each	$2.98	$2.98
☐ White mushrooms, loose	520 g	loose, by weight	$1.32/100 g	$6.86
☐ Yellow onions	380 g	1 x 3 lb bag	$4.99	$1.39
☐ Yellow potatoes	1 kg	1 x 10 lb bag	$6.99	$1.54
Meat & deli				
☐ Chicken breast, boneless skinless, warehouse pack	1.3 kg	2 x about 1.25 kg	$20.64	$21.47
Dairy & eggs				
☐ Cottage cheese 2% (Dairyland)	2.25 kg	3 x 750 g	$8.25	$24.75
☐ Extra firm tofu (Sunrise)	4.53 block	5 x 350 g	$3.99	$18.07
☐ Feta (Tre Stelle)	76 g	1 x 375 g	$8.99	$1.82
☐ Greek yogurt, plain 2% (Olympic)	1.93 kg	2 x 1.75 kg	$12.29	$13.52
☐ Large white eggs	30	2 x 18	$7.45	$12.42
☐ Medium cheddar block (Western Family)	240 g	1 x 600 g	$8.49	$3.40
☐ Salted butter (Western Family)	87 g	1 x 454 g	$6.69	$1.28
Grains & bakery				
☐ Classic baguette (Bake Shop)	1	1 x 350 g	$3.49	$3.49
☐ Green lentils, bulk bin	400 g	loose, by weight	$0.89/100 g	$3.56
☐ Large flake oats (Rogers)	270 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.00	$1.35
☐ Long grain brown rice (Western Family)	536 g	1 x 907 g	$3.99	$2.36
☐ Panko bread crumbs (Western Family)	25 g	1 x 227 g	$3.59	$0.40
☐ Sourdough bread, sliced (Bake Shop)	31 slice	3 x 567 g, about 12 slices	$3.99	$10.31
Pantry & cans				
☐ Diced tomatoes in juice (Western Family)	400 mL	1 x 796 mL can	$2.39	$1.20
☐ Extra virgin olive oil (Western Family)	45 mL	1 x 1 L	$15.99	$0.72
☐ Liquid honey (Western Family)	255 g	1 x 1 kg	$14.79	$3.77
☐ Mini semi-sweet chocolate chips (Chipits)	90 g	1 x 270 g	$6.79	$2.26
☐ Mirin (Kikkoman Kotteri)	120 mL	1 x 296 mL	$6.99	$2.83
☐ Natural smooth peanut butter (Western Family)	128 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.99	$0.76
☐ Natural whole almonds, bulk bin	202 g	loose, by weight	$1.99/100 g	$4.03
☐ Pure sesame oil (Kosa)	10 mL	1 x 185 mL	$3.99	$0.22
☐ Soy sauce, less sodium (Western Family)	165 mL	1 x 450 mL	$3.49	$1.28
☐ Vegetable broth, low sodium (Western Family)	1.5 L	2 x 946 mL	$2.49	$3.95
Frozen				
☐ Frozen edamame beans (Western Family)	300 g	1 x 500 g	$2.99	$1.79
Allowance for spices, oil, vinegar and the H Mart items below (my estimate, not priced)				**$6.00**
Groceries used for this option, both of you				**$197.97**
At the till if every pack is bought new (the remainder carries into later weeks)				**$336.10**

Cook and split: Spring option 2

In cooking order. The outline is a reminder in my words; follow the linked recipe for amounts of seasoning and exact steps.

Lentil soup SUNDAY

For Mon, Tue and Wed lunches · Make the recipe once (6 servings) · about 55 min · full recipe: recipetineats.com/lentil-soup (RecipeTin Eats)

BUY FOR IT	30 mL extra virgin olive oil; 150 g yellow onions; 0.2 bulb garlic; 150 g carrots; 150 g celery; 400 g green lentils, bulk bin; 400 mL diced tomatoes in juice; 1.5 L vegetable broth, low sodium; 1 lemon. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Soften onion and garlic, then carrot and celery, slowly. 2. Add lentils, tomato, broth and spices; simmer about 35 min. 3. Blitz a little of it to thicken, finish with lemon.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Mon, Tue and Wed lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: 1 slice sourdough. Her: 1 slice sourdough, cheddar 30 g.
KEEP	5 days in the fridge, 3 months in the freezer (author).
REHEAT	Microwave 2 to 3 min with a splash of water.
ALLERGENS	None of the major allergens (check the broth label)
NOTE	Meatless (made with vegetable broth) and the cheapest pot in the plan.

Egg muffins SUNDAY

For breakfasts, Mon to Fri · Make 2 x the recipe (24 muffins) · about 40 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/healthy-breakfast-egg-muffins (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	60 g baby spinach; 1 red bell pepper; 1 green bell pepper; 220 g grape tomatoes; 20 large white eggs; 76 g feta. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Divide spinach, peppers and tomatoes among greased muffin cups. 2. Whisk eggs, whites and seasoning; pour over and top with feta. 3. Bake at 350 F about 25 min.
SPLIT	Each weekday: 2 muffins for him, 2 muffins for her. 4 left over for the weekend or the freezer.
SIDES	Him: 2 slices sourdough, Greek yogurt 175 g. Her: 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple.
KEEP	3 days in the fridge, 3 months in the freezer (author). Freeze Thursday's and Friday's.
REHEAT	Microwave 30 to 45 s from the fridge, about 60 s from frozen.
ALLERGENS	Eggs, milk (feta)
NOTE	The tomatoes are baked in. To keep his completely tomato-free, leave them out of half the cups.

Granola bars SUNDAY

For snacks, Mon to Fri · Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (15 bars) · about 135 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/healthy-granola-bars (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	270 g large flake oats; 202 g natural whole almonds, bulk bin; 255 g liquid honey; 128 g natural smooth peanut butter; 90 g mini semi-sweet chocolate chips. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Toast oats, nuts and seeds. 2. Warm honey with peanut butter, stir in vanilla, cinnamon and the toasted mix; fold in chips. 3. Press firmly into a lined pan, chill 2 hours, cut into 10.
SPLIT	Every day including the weekend: 1 bar for him, 1 bar for her. 1 left over for the weekend or the freezer.
SIDES	Him: cottage cheese 125 g. Her: cottage cheese 125 g.
KEEP	1 week at room temperature, 2 weeks in the fridge, 2 months frozen (author).
REHEAT	Eat as is.
ALLERGENS	Peanuts, tree nuts; chocolate chips usually contain milk and soy

Kopytka (potato dumplings) MONDAY EVENING

For Mon and Tue dinners · Make the recipe once (8 servings) · about 40 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-kopytka-dumplings (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT	1 kg yellow potatoes; 2 large white eggs; 42 g salted butter; 25 g panko bread crumbs. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Boil the potatoes in their skins, peel, mash or rice them and cool. 2. Knead quickly with flour, eggs and salt. 3. Roll into thumb-thick ropes and cut into small diagonal pieces. 4. Boil in salted water until they float; top with butter-toasted breadcrumbs.
SPLIT	Set 3 servings aside first for the freezer or the weekend. Divide the rest into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Mon and Tue dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.4 of the recipe's servings, hers about 1.1.
SIDES	Him: 100 g diced chicken. Her: cottage cheese 125 g.
KEEP	The page gives no storage time; the author says to reheat by frying or in the microwave. My guidance: 3 days in the fridge; freeze the spare dumplings on a tray.
REHEAT	Fry gently in a little butter (author's preference), or microwave 60 to 90 s.
ALLERGENS	Wheat, eggs, milk (butter)
NOTE	You also need about 325 g of flour from the pantry. The recipe makes 8 servings: this plan eats 5 over two nights and freezes 3.

Teriyaki tofu bowls WEDNESDAY EVENING

For Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches · Make 2 x the recipe (4 servings) · about 30 min · full recipe: justonecookbook.com/teriyaki-tofu-bowl (Just One Cookbook)

BUY FOR IT	2.26 block extra firm tofu; 120 mL mirin; 120 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 0.4 bunch green onions. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Drain and press the tofu, slice it and dust with starch. 2. Whisk sake, mirin, soy and sugar for the teriyaki sauce. 3. Pan-fry the tofu until golden on both sides, pour in the sauce and reduce until glossy. 4. Serve over rice with scallions and sesame seeds.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 0.76 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.57.
SIDES	Him: 1/2 cup brown rice. Her: 3/4 cup brown rice, edamame 100 g.
KEEP	3 days in an airtight container; the author advises against freezing tofu.
REHEAT	Microwave 60 to 90 s with the rice.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame
H MART	Cooking sake (or any dry sake)
NOTE	The recipe serves 2, so this plan doubles it. Its nutrition figure does not appear to include the rice, so rice is counted as a side. Sake is not costed.

Tofu stir fry THURSDAY EVENING

For Thu and Fri dinners · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 25 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/tofu-stir-fry (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	2.27 block extra firm tofu; 45 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 0.3 bulb garlic; 1 bunch green onions; 15 g fresh ginger; 283 g baby spinach; 10 mL pure sesame oil. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Dry and cube the tofu; fry it in hot oil until golden, seasoning with soy. 2. Add garlic, scallions, ginger and chili paste. 3. Wilt in the spinach by the handful; finish with sesame seeds and sesame oil.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Thu and Fri dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: 1 1/4 cup brown rice. Her: 1 cup brown rice.
KEEP	Up to 5 days in the fridge (author).
REHEAT	Microwave gently, 60 to 90 s (author).
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame
HEAT	Leave the chili paste out of the pan; he adds it at the table.
NOTE	Meatless.

Barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht) SATURDAY MIDDAY

For Saturday and Sunday lunches · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 105 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-red-borscht-vegan (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT	400 g beets, loose; 160 g carrots; 245 g celery root; 220 g white mushrooms, loose; 1 leek; 150 g yellow onions; 0.2 bulb garlic; 0.5 ambrosia apple; 15 mL extra virgin olive oil. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Roast beets, carrots, root vegetables, mushrooms, leek, onion, garlic and herbs at 425 F until golden, 30 to 40 min. 2. Deglaze the pan, then simmer everything with water, bay, allspice, juniper, cloves, a prune or two and dried mushrooms. 3. Strain, then stir in the beet kvass and marjoram; season to taste.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: 1 slice sourdough. Her: 1 slice sourdough, cottage cheese 125 g.
KEEP	Up to 7 days in the fridge in a lidded container (author).
REHEAT	Reheat gently, 2 min in the microwave; do not boil it hard or the colour dulls.
ALLERGENS	None of the major allergens (sulphites if you use the wine)
NOTE	Polish barszcz czerwony, the clear beet broth, not the chunky Ukrainian soup. It needs about 500 mL of beet kvass (zakwas), a few dried wild mushrooms and 2 prunes, none of which are costed: a Polish deli sells kvass, or the author links her own 5 day recipe. It is a light soup, so it is paired with bread and something more filling.

Zapiekanka SATURDAY EVENING

For Saturday and Sunday dinners · Make the recipe once (2 servings) · about 30 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-zapiekanka (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT	1 classic baguette; 300 g white mushrooms, loose; 80 g yellow onions; 150 g medium cheddar block. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Halve the baguette lengthwise and scoop out a little crumb. 2. Saute chopped mushrooms and onion 7 to 10 min; season. 3. Fill the bread, cover with grated cheese and bake until golden. 4. Finish with ketchup.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 0.57 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.43.
SIDES	Him: Greek yogurt 175 g. Her: Greek yogurt 175 g.
KEEP	The page gives no storage time. My guidance: cook the mushroom filling once, keep it 2 days, and bake the second night's halves fresh.
REHEAT	Bake 8 to 10 min at 400 F rather than microwaving.
ALLERGENS	Wheat, milk
NOTE	Polish street food. Costed with medium cheddar; the recipe suggests a mild cheese such as gouda.